GeoNews — Week 43/2026

Weekly digest on Quaternary palaeoclimate research, East African Rift dynamics, palaeohydrology and time-series analysis · 19 October 2026

> **What is GeoNews?** An **automatically compiled weekly digest**. A research workflow scans publications from the past one to two weeks as well as funding, policy and community sources, scores the hits against a fixed set of criteria and assembles this issue from them.
>
> The thematic profile follows **the research interests of Markus L. Fischer** (Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam): Quaternary palaeoclimate and palaeoenvironmental reconstruction, the East African Rift, the African Humid Period and human–environment coupling, lake-level and water-balance modelling, palaeofloods and fluvial geomorphology, ICDP drill cores, and linear and nonlinear time-series analysis. Researchers in these fields will probably find something useful here — it is explicitly not a complete overview of Quaternary science.
>
> Selection, scoring and summaries are machine-generated and reviewed before publication. Details may contain errors; when in doubt, the linked original source prevails.

Each paper receives a score of 0–100 from five criteria: topical fit (40), methodological fit (25), impact/venue (15), connectivity (10) and recency (10). Categories: 🔴 75 and above must-read · 🟡 50–74 relevant · 🟢 30–49 radar. The score measures proximity to this newsletter's profile and prioritises reading — it is not a quality judgement on the individual paper.

In brief

About three dozen scored papers, with **four 🔴 must-reads** this week, all based on abstracts. There is no direct primary hit from the East African Rift this time; the emphasis is on **time-series methods applied to lake and cave archives** and on **drill cores from Alpine lakes**.

At the top is a *Quaternary Science Reviews* study that uses an EMD variant and the Hilbert transform on **five high-resolution lake records from China** to quantify **decadal dry–wet shifts** over the last millennium; according to the abstract, their frequency increases with the contrast of the centennial background state. The other 🔴: an **ICDP core from the Lago Maggiore system** with an abrupt lake-level drop at ~9 ka, the **non-stationary coupling of the East Asian summer monsoon** to the Pacific and North Atlantic from three laminated stalagmites, and ***Etheria elliptica* shells from the middle Atbara River** (eastern Sudan, draining the Ethiopian Highlands), which according to the abstract point to precipitation seasonality persisting for at least ~200 kyr.

In the 🟡 block: an **abrupt regime shift to a hotter, drier climate in the Western Eurasian Steppe** (*Nature Geoscience*; early-warning framing), a pollen-based LGM-to-present reconstruction from an **annually laminated maar lake**, proxy-withholding experiments on **the weight of individual archive types in palaeo data assimilation**, demographic responses to the **Kikai-Akahoya eruption**, and a new **1.5-Myr compilation of glacial and interglacial intensities** across the Mid-Pleistocene Transition.

On funding, with the ERC Starting Grant deadline (14 Oct) passed, the **ERC Consolidator Grant (12 Jan 2027)** is the next major date; the **Horizon Europe palaeoclimate call** opens on **17 Nov 2026**. On policy: the **WissZeitVG reform** had its **first reading in the Bundestag on 8 Oct 2026**, and the federal government rejects the Bundesrat's central demand. The **European Council** continued negotiations on the 2028–2034 MFF on 15–16 Oct — the aim remains an agreement by year-end.

Part A — Papers of the week

Covered are papers with a Crossref `created` date from 5 October 2026 onwards that were not listed in a previous issue. For every entry with an accessible abstract (OpenAlex, Crossref or publisher page), the assessment is based on that abstract; titles without an available abstract are marked ⚠ *title-based*.

Must-read (75 and above)

1. Tracking decadal dry–wet shifts over the past millennium in China: Insights from five high-resolution lake records · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, 2026 · **Score 87** Five well-dated, high-resolution lacustrine precipitation records (Gonghai, Nvshan, Jiangcuo, Kusai, Sihailongwan) are decomposed using regenerated phase-shifted sinusoid-assisted empirical mode decomposition (RPSEMD) combined with the Hilbert transform to extract decadal hydroclimate variability and identify dry–wet shifts quantitatively. Findings according to the abstract: regional coherence alongside local divergence — more frequent shifts during the Medieval Climate Anomaly at Gonghai, but concentrated in the Little Ice Age at Nvshan, Kusai and Sihailongwan; little difference at Jiangcuo. The frequency of decadal shifts correlates positively with the contrast of the centennial background state; the authors conclude that longer-term states may influence the frequency and magnitude of higher-frequency variability (interpretation; mechanism open, with roles for the monsoon, westerlies and local hydrology). Methodologically transferable to high-resolution rift-lake records: the same question of state-dependent variability that tipping-point and regime analyses ask. *Topic 38 · Method 22 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 14 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110338

2. New constraints on the postglacial evolution of Lago Maggiore, Northern Italy · *Journal of Quaternary Science*, 2026 · **Score 78** A 58-m **ICDP core** from the lower Ossola Valley (an overdeepened valley at the southern margin of the Alps, ~500 m of infill), studied with sedimentology, geotechnics, luminescence and radiocarbon dating, and placed in a reflection-seismic context. Findings according to the abstract: a coarse basal interval overlain by ~35 m of silts and sands representing an ice-retreat and glaciolacustrine sequence; a distinct transition to sandier, more heterogeneous lake deposits is attributed to a dam breach with lake-level drop and sudden delta progradation at ca. 9 ka. A clustering of mass movements in other Alpine lakes at 9.5–10 ka might point to a major earthquake as a common source (framed by the authors as a possibility); at ca. 7 ka the site fell dry. The causes of the lake-level drops remain open according to the abstract. Relevant for ICDP lake-core chronologies and Central European lake-sediment archives. *Topic 36 · Method 16 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10 (created 12 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1002/jqs.70122

3. Non-stationary evolution of centennial to decadal East Asian summer monsoon variability modulated by trans-oceanic interactions over the last millennium · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, 2026 · **Score 77** $\delta^{18}O$ records from three annually laminated,

replicated stalagmites from eastern China covering the last millennium. Findings according to the abstract: segmented correlation analysis reveals four stages in the spatial pattern of monsoon rainfall, synchronised with Northern Hemisphere temperature (meridional displacement of the frontal rainfall belt). The first principal component is non-stationary: during warm periods a 20–40-year periodicity linked to the PDO dominates; in the Little Ice Age this coupling weakens and a ~50-year periodicity linked to Atlantic Multidecadal Variability emerges. CESM Last Millennium Ensemble simulations attribute this Atlantic variability mainly to volcanic forcing. Relevant as an example of time-dependent spectral and coupling analysis on proxy series — methodologically close to nonlinear time-series analysis. *Topic 30 · Method 20 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 13 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110309

4. Paleoseasonality through serial stable isotope analysis of Pleistocene to recent *Etheria elliptica* shells from the middle Atbara River, eastern Sudan · *E&G Quaternary Science Journal*, 2026 · **Score 76** Serial $\delta^{18}O$ and $\delta^{13}C$ analyses of 11 fossil and three modern shells of the freshwater oyster *Etheria elliptica* from the middle Atbara River (eastern Sudan; the Atbara drains the Ethiopian Highlands), with the fossils OSL-dated to ~224 to ~17 ka, plus a local meteoric water line from seven river-water samples. Findings according to the abstract: fossil shells are enriched in $\delta^{18}O$ (possibly drier, more evaporative Pleistocene conditions — though the authors also name dams as a cause of more depleted modern values); $\delta^{13}C$ differences are linked in part to atmospheric CO_2, with alternative explanations (vegetation, weathering, biological factors) left open. The authors' overall conclusion: strong precipitation seasonality has likely persisted in eastern Sudan since at least ~200 ka. Regionally connected to highland runoff records and to the question of how far seasonality and annual means varied separately during north-east African humid phases. *Topic 38 · Method 13 · Venue 7 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10 (created 14 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.5194/egqsj-75-173-2026

Relevant (50–74)

5. An abrupt shift towards a hotter and drier climate regime in the Western Eurasian Steppe · *Nature Geoscience*, 2026 · **Score 74** Reanalysis data plus large-ensemble and multi-model simulations identify an abrupt regime shift in the Western Eurasian Steppe, with unprecedented summer drying beyond the range of natural variability of the past century and no clear recovery over the observational period (1901–2024). According to the abstract, external forcing provides the background drying while internal variability amplified the trend since the early 1990s; declining soil moisture intensifies heat and deficits through land–atmosphere feedback. The authors present the region as an early warning signal for other mid-latitude drylands. Not a palaeo paper — but the same question as in palaeo tipping-point research: when does a trend become a persistent change of state? *Topic 28 · Method 15 · Venue 15 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 12 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1038/s41561-026-02125-8

6. High-Resolution Temperature and Precipitation Variability in Northeast Asia Since the Last Glacial Maximum Recorded in an Annually Laminated Maar Lake · *Journal of Geophysical Research: Atmospheres*, 2026 · **Score 74** Pollen-based reconstructions of mean annual temperature and precipitation from Xiaolongwan maar lake from the LGM to the present. Findings according to the abstract: increases of ~9.0 ± 2.2 °C and ~470 ± 121 mm from the LGM to the mid-Holocene; between ~19.0 and 17.0 kyr b2k temperature drops markedly while precipitation stays within uncertainty — a decoupling the authors attribute to different forcings (high latitudes vs. monsoon/western Pacific SST). Across the Bølling-Allerød, Younger Dryas and early Holocene both shift rapidly and largely simultaneously. Relevant for proxy approaches that

implicitly assume temperature and precipitation co-vary. *Topic 34 · Method 13 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 12 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1029/2026jd047113

7. Differential Impacts of Proxy Archives on Paleoclimate Reconstruction Performance · *Journal of Geophysical Research: Atmospheres*, 2026 · **Score 73** Proxy-withholding experiments in palaeo data assimilation quantify the marginal contribution of eight archive types (corals, tree rings, speleothems, documentary records, lake sediments, marine sediments, glaciers, ground ice) to ENSO, the Indian Ocean Dipole, global mean temperature and global mean precipitation. Findings according to the abstract: assimilation consistently improves skill, with the multi-model ensemble as the most stable prior; corals are indispensable for all indices, while documentary records and speleothems add key information in monsoon-sensitive, data-sparse regions; some archives have outsized leverage relative to their coverage. Relevant to the question of how much additional lake-sediment records from data-sparse regions such as East Africa would add to reconstructions. *Topic 30 · Method 16 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 12 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1029/2025jd045958

8. Divergent demographic responses to the Kikai-Akahoya volcanic catastrophe in mid-Holocene Japan · *Science Advances*, 2026 · **Score 71** Statistical models of the demographic and environmental consequences of the K-Ah eruption (~7300 years ago) for Jōmon communities. Findings according to the abstract: population collapse in regions immediately adjacent to the volcano, but increases in some proximal populations; some distal communities were affected by previously overlooked environmental consequences. The authors read this as a contingent rather than deterministic response to a shock. Methodologically transferable to human–environment questions at wet–dry transitions (e.g. the end of the African Humid Period). *Topic 25 · Method 15 · Venue 15 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 14 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1126/sciadv.aeh7197

9. Glacial and interglacial intensities across the Mid-Pleistocene Transition from a new 1.5 Myr long compilation of marine and terrestrial records · *EGUsphere* (preprint, in discussion), 2026 · **Score 70** A compilation of 29 palaeoclimate records over 1.5 Myr, half marine and half terrestrial, with intensity measures for each glacial and interglacial. Findings according to the abstract: glacial amplification from MIS 22 (~930 ka) in both marine and terrestrial archives; no consistent trend in interglacial strength in terrestrial records; MIS 13a weak in marine but strong in several terrestrial records; since the Mid-Brunhes Shift a linear relationship between interglacial strength and the preceding glacial in benthic $\delta^{18}O$, but not in other archive types. Comes with an interactive dashboard. Relevant for long terrestrial drill-core records and their synchronisation. Not yet peer-reviewed. *Topic 34 · Method 16 · Venue 4 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 13 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.5194/egusphere-2026-6154

10. Late Quaternary evolution of river Nile at Wadi Kubbaniya, Egypt: Insights from mineralogy and geochemistry proxies · *Journal of African Earth Sciences*, 2026 · **Score 70** · ⚠ *title-based* Late Quaternary evolution of the Nile at Wadi Kubbaniya (Upper Egypt) from mineralogical and geochemical proxies. Close to the profile through fluvial geomorphology and the Nile as an integrator of East African highland rainfall. Without an accessible abstract (neither OpenAlex nor Crossref; publisher page not reachable), the assessment rests on title, journal and topic; time span, dating and findings are subject to confirmation. *Topic 34 · Method 13 · Venue 7 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 12 Oct 2026)* · DOI: 10.1016/j.jafrearsci.2026.106406

Radar

- **Hydroclimatic changes in southeastern Mongolia from the earlier Late Pleistocene to the mid-Holocene: a multi-proxy record from a glacier-decoupled closed-basin**

sedimentary sequence in Bayan Tohom Gobi · *Quaternary International* · **69** ● · 3.88-m profile from a closed basin, AMS ^{14}C and OSL, end-member modelling and PCA: effective moisture and sediment mobility governed by precipitation, runoff, groundwater and evaporation; comparison with Ulaan and Orog Nuur highlights catchment controls. DOI: 10.1016/j.quaint.2026.110498 · created 15 Oct 2026

- **Palaeoclimate constraints narrow uncertainty in future Arctic winter sea ice projections** · *Nature Geoscience* · **68** ● · Arctic-wide mid-Holocene biomarker database plus a Bayesian model-weighting scheme (proxy system model, model interdependence, non-stationary proxy seasonality): according to the abstract, uncertainty reduced by 85% and weighted projections nearly 1 million km² lower winter ice. Methodologically interesting for Bayesian data–model comparison. DOI: 10.1038/s41561-026-02123-w · created 16 Oct 2026
- **Human-enhanced tsunami hazard in large lakes** · *Nature Communications* · **66** ● · Lake Iseo: two millennia of intensified land use tripled sediment flux and oversteepened the delta; according to geological records and modelling, earthquakes in 1117 and 1222 CE triggered subaqueous delta collapses with run-ups of up to ~50 m. Human–environment coupling in an Alpine lake archive. DOI: 10.1038/s41467-026-78272-8 · created 15 Oct 2026
- **Hydroclimatic thresholds and state-dependent vegetation responses in the Mediterranean during the intensification of Northern Hemisphere glaciation** · *Global and Planetary Change* · **65** ● · ⚠ *title-based* · Thresholds and state-dependent vegetation responses in the Mediterranean during the intensification of Northern Hemisphere glaciation; linked to tipping-point/threshold concepts, findings subject to confirmation. DOI: 10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105759 · created 12 Oct 2026
- **Reconstructing early hominin behavioural ecology: a modelling approach** · *Frontiers in Ecology and Evolution* · **62** ● · Climate-driven time-budget models (derived from baboon and chimpanzee models) only predict the known distribution of australopithecines with a dedicated model; according to the authors, use of lacustrine and riverine floodplains and declining group sizes after ~2.4 Ma. Model assumptions shape the conclusions. DOI: 10.3389/fevo.2026.1891539 · created 15 Oct 2026
- **Hydroclimate Variability in the Western Pacific Warm Pool Over the Last 15 kyr** · *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology* · **62** ● · Plant-wax δD/δ^{13}C and element ratios from a core off Papua New Guinea plus isotope-enabled CESM runs; according to the abstract, a distinct mid-Holocene signal. DOI: 10.1029/2026pa005515 · created 17 Oct 2026
- **Hydroclimate variability in southern Portugal during marine isotope stage 4** · *Journal of Quaternary Science* · **61** ● · Stalagmite (δ^{13}C, δ^{18}O, Mg) from southern Portugal: a high-resolution continental record for MIS 4, complementing the coarsely resolved Iberian archives. DOI: 10.1002/jqs.70128 · created 16 Oct 2026
- **Evaluation of the Rb/Sr ratio as an indicator of chemical weathering: a case study from five sedimentary sections in Northeast China** · *Boreas* · **61** ● · Comparison of Rb/Sr with common weathering indices (CIA, CIW, PIA and others) at five terrestrial profiles; relevant for interpreting XRF element ratios in sediment cores. DOI: 10.1111/bor.70087 · created 15 Oct 2026
- **Chronology of the short-term climate changes during the Holocene in northwestern Russia and its correlation with the solar activity variations** · *Radiocarbon* · **61** ● · Bayesian age modelling (OxCal, Bronk Ramsey) of existing ^{14}C series from three raised bogs to account for short-term ^{14}C variations (dating errors up to ~300 years); the solar correlation is the authors' interpretation. DOI: 10.1017/rdc.2026.10268 · created 19 Oct 2026

- **Climate warming redistributes the seasonality of inland open-water evaporation** · *Global and Planetary Change* · **60** 🟡 · CLM lake model (RCP8.5): open-water evaporation rises mainly in warm seasons of arid and temperate climates; net radiation dominates, wind is secondary. Relevant for seasonally resolved lake water balances. DOI: 10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105750 · created 7 Oct 2026
- **A long-term trend toward wetter conditions during MIS 2 inferred from modern-monitoring-based stalagmite multi-proxy records from Remi Cave, Central China** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **60** 🟡 · Four years of cave monitoring plus a multi-proxy stalagmite
(~25.7–14.5 kyr BP) addressing the hydroclimate debate in the Yangtze valley. DOI: 10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110324 · created 7 Oct 2026
- **A mosaic of technologies: Chronological and lithic evidence for late Middle Pleistocene population dynamics in Sudanese Nubia (Northeast Africa)** · *Quaternary International* · **60** 🟡 · ⚠ *title-based* · Chronology and lithics on late Middle Pleistocene population dynamics in north-east Africa. DOI: 10.1016/j.quaint.2026.110487 · created 16 Oct 2026
- **Late Holocene transition from natural to anthropogenic forcing of lake archaeal community dynamics in semi-arid northern China** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **59** 🟡 · Sedimentary DNA from Lake Gouchi: Holocene archaeal communities dominated by halophilic taxa, with a transition to anthropogenic influence in the late Holocene. DOI: 10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110325 · created 14 Oct 2026
- **Hydroclimatic instability during the late Roman Warm Period–early Dark Ages Cold Period transition in the eastern Mediterranean** · *EGUsphere* (preprint) · **58** 🟡 · Near-annually resolved stalagmite (Börtlüce Cave, western Türkiye, 154–529 CE): pronounced multi-decadal variability during the 290–430 CE transition. DOI: 10.5194/egusphere-2026-5713 · created 14 Oct 2026
- **High- and Low-Latitude Insolation Forcing Drives the Half-Precession Cycle in Winter Arctic Sea Ice** · *Geophysical Research Letters* · **56** 🟡 · Transient 800-kyr simulation: an eccentricity-modulated half-precession cycle in Arctic winter sea ice. Linked to half-precession signals in tropical records. DOI: 10.1029/2026gl125062 · created 5 Oct 2026
- **The co-evolution of hominins and Stone Age culture** · *Proceedings of the Royal Society B* · **55** 🟡 · Review (no primary data) of gene–culture co-evolution since before ~3.3 Ma. DOI: 10.1098/rspb.2026.0772 · created 14 Oct 2026
- **Palynological and geochemical records of glacial-interglacial differences in River Terraces: A case study of the Qingyi River, Eastern Qinghai-Xizang Plateau** · *Geomorphology* · **55** 🟡 · ⚠ *title-based* · River terraces as glacial–interglacial archives. DOI: 10.1016/j.geomorph.2026.110577 · created 17 Oct 2026
- **Using ocean surface paleo-density to evaluate PMIP3 and PMIP4 Last Glacial Maximum climate simulations** · *Climate of the Past* · **51** 🟡 · δ^{18}Oc-based surface density as a benchmark for PMIP LGM runs. Open access. DOI: 10.5194/cp-22-1803-2026 · created 6 Oct 2026
- **Hominin behavior, strategies, and environmental conditions in Southern Europe (Marine Isotope Stage 17–15): The 100-ka sequence of Notarchirico (Italy, 700–600 ka)** · *Journal of Human Evolution* · **49** 🟢 · Technological stability with rare bifaces over a 100-ka sequence. DOI: 10.1016/j.jhevol.2026.103897 · created 15 Oct 2026

- **LIPOTHERM: A Calibration Framework for GDGT Paleothermometry Based on Machine Learning** · *Geochemistry, Geophysics, Geosystems* · **48** ● · ML-based GDGT–SST calibration accounting for non-thermal controls. DOI: 10.1029/2026gc013071 · created 5 Oct 2026
- **From manual classification to transformer-based language models: assessing the quality and consistency of historical convective event records** · *Climate of the Past* · **48** ● · Historical thunderstorm and hail reports, structured and analysed with a multilingual BERT model. DOI: 10.5194/cp-22-1833-2026 · created 7 Oct 2026
- **Geochemical profiling, pedogenesis, and paleoclimate: Understanding stone age archaeological context of Dulung River Valley, Eastern India** · *Archaeological Research in Asia* · **48** ● · Palaeosol geochemistry as environmental context for fluvial sites. DOI: 10.1016/j.ara.2026.100757 · created 17 Oct 2026
- **Grain Size Analysis of Karewa Palaeolake Sediments and its implication on depositional dynamics** · *Journal of Earth System Science* · **47** ● · ⚠ *title-based* · Grain size of a palaeolake in the Kashmir valley. DOI: 10.1007/s12040-026-02981-3 · created 5 Oct 2026
- **First assessment of Pleistocene and Holocene archaeological sites at Tchitundu-Hulu, Namibe Province, Angola** · *L'Anthropologie* · **41** ● · First techno-typological assessment of sites on the north-eastern margin of the Namib. DOI: 10.1016/j.anthro.2026.103526 · created 10 Oct 2026

Not listed or only noted: Excluded because already listed in earlier issues are, among others, the Chew Bahir Sr study (QSR 110308), the Caspian record (QSR 110327), the Chilika and playa records (P³ 114269, 114285) and the npj obliquity study. Not included: a *Nature Communications* short item "Early warnings of earthquakes" (no palaeo link, not a primary article) and numerous topic-query hits without a geoscience link ("early warning", "Rift Valley Fever").

Part B — Funding & calls

ERC Consolidator Grant 2027 — deadline 12 Jan 2027. Open since 24 Sep 2026; eligibility per ERC Work Programme 2027 (typically 7–12 years after the PhD). Source: ERC — Consolidator Grant.

ERC 2027 — further dates. According to a summary of the 2027 Work Programme: **Proof of Concept** opens 12 Nov 2026 (first cut-off 10 Mar 2027), **Synergy Grant** 17 Feb – 11 May 2027, **Advanced Grant** 27 May – 26 Aug 2027. Please check dates on the ERC website before planning. Source: Hezelburcht — ERC Work Programme 2027.

Horizon Europe — "Palaeoclimate science for a better understanding of Earth system dynamics" (HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-08). Opens **17 Nov 2026**, deadline **4 Mar 2027**, Research and Innovation Action, about €14 million for roughly two projects (as in the previous issue, unchanged). Source: Topic page.

ICDP — 2027 proposal cycle. Recurring deadline of **15 January** for pre-, workshop, full and fast-track proposals; ICDP recommends submitting pre-proposals at least two months earlier and fast-track letters of intent "at least by early November". The 2027 date is not formally confirmed. Source: ICDP — Proposal Preparation.

ICDP — AGU 2026 travel grants for early-career researchers — deadline 8 Nov 2026. Several grants of US$300 for presenting ICDP-related research at the AGU Fall Meeting (CV + accepted abstract). Source: PAGES Newsletter October 2026.

DFG — Open Access publication funding. Institutional applications due for the first time by **4 May 2027** (as in the previous issue). Source: DFG — Information für die Wissenschaft No. 68.

Part C — Science policy (DE/EU)

WissZeitVG — first reading in the Bundestag, government rejects Bundesrat demand. The government bill on "modernising fixed-term employment law in science" (Bundestag printed paper 21/8281 of 30 Sep 2026) had its first reading on **8 Oct 2026** and was referred, together with a Die Linke motion to abolish the special fixed-term regime (21/8384), to the research committee. Core elements: minimum terms for first contracts (three years before, two years after the doctorate), family-related extensions also for third-party-funded contracts, a new two-year care extension, at least a quarter of regular working time for qualification contracts, maximum duration for student assistants of eight instead of six years, evaluation in 2032. The government rejects the Bundesrat's demand that contracts below the minimum term be treated as running for that minimum, pointing to general labour law instead. The research committee's agenda of 14 Oct 2026 included a decision on holding a public hearing. Assessment: for third-party-funded postdoc positions with short project durations, the minimum term remains the most consequential lever in practice. Sources: Bundestag — text archive week 41 · BT-Drs. 21/8281 (PDF) · Research committee agenda 14 Oct 2026 (PDF).

Federal budget 2027 — research committee consulted. On 14 Oct 2026 the committee discussed the 2027 Budget Act (BT-Drs. 21/7300) in closed session; the budget committee remains in the lead. State of the government draft: BMFTR core budget about €22 billion, nominally about +0.7% (as in the previous issue). Sources: Research committee agenda (PDF) · Forschung & Lehre — Only a small increase for the BMFTR core budget.

EU — European Council continues MFF 2028–2034 negotiations. At the summit on 15–16 Oct 2026, leaders discussed an updated negotiating box from the Irish Presidency; the aim remains an agreement before the end of 2026 so that legislative acts can be adopted in 2027 and funding continues without interruption from January 2028. According to Agence Europe, an agreement only after 2026 no longer appears to be ruled out. The Council fixed its position on the next research framework programme (FP10) in June; university associations continue to call for substantially higher budgets (Austria's uniko, for instance, €200 billion). Assessment: as long as the MFF is open, the FP10 budget — and thus the size of the ERC from 2028 — remains undetermined. Sources: European Council — conclusions 15–16 Oct 2026 · Agence Europe · Council — position on FP10 (26 Jun 2026) · TOP News — uniko on FP10.

Part D — Community & dates

- **EGU General Assembly 2027** — **4–9 Apr 2027**, Vienna; abstract submission opens on **28 Oct 2026** according to the PAGES newsletter (deadline usually mid-January, not verified). Source: PAGES Newsletter October 2026.
- **PAGES** — **Data Science Officer** position at the International Project Office in Bern; according to the previous issue, review of applications from **2 Nov 2026**. Source: PAGES — News.

- **ICDP AGU 2026 travel grants** — deadline **8 Nov 2026**.
- **ERC Proof of Concept** — opens **12 Nov 2026**.
- **Horizon CL5 palaeoclimate call** — opens **17 Nov 2026**, deadline **4 Mar 2027**.
- **AGU Fall Meeting 2026** — **7–11 Dec 2026**, San Francisco. Source: AGU.
- **ERC Consolidator Grant 2027** — deadline **12 Jan 2027**.
- **ICDP** — proposal deadline expected **15 Jan 2027**.
- **PAGES dates 2027** — workshop "Coastal Hypoxia through the Common Era" **27–29 Apr 2027** (Qingdao); PALSEA-Next **24–26 Jun 2027** (Dartmouth College); **PMIP conference 30 Aug – 3 Sep 2027** (Rio de Janeiro). Source: PAGES Newsletter October 2026.
- **IPCC AR7** — the expert review of the Working Group II first-order draft was due to open "in early October" according to the IPCC Chair; exact deadlines could not be verified at the time of writing. Source: IPCC — 2026.

Methods & sources

Paper screening follows the fixed criteria (topical fit, methodological fit, impact/venue, connectivity, recency) and excludes DOIs already listed in a previous issue. Funding opportunities, science policy and dates are based on the sources linked in Parts B to D.

How this issue was produced. Direct network access from the computing environment was blocked. **OpenAlex** (ISSN queries of the core journals with `from_publication_date:2026-10-05`, topic and title searches; abstracts reconstructed from the `abstract_inverted_index`) and the **Crossref REST API** (ISSN queries including Quaternary International, The Holocene, J. African Earth Sci., Geomorphology, J. Human Evolution, GRL, G-cubed, Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology; topic queries; `created` dates of all listed papers) were queried via the integrated browser interface (`fetch()`); one abstract was taken from the publisher page (Nature Portfolio). ScienceDirect landing pages were not reachable.

What this means for coverage. Where neither OpenAlex nor Crossref holds an abstract, the entry is marked ⚠ *title-based*;
no results beyond the title were invented. Dates given are Crossref `created` dates (registration), which may differ from the online publication date by a few days. Topic queries return a lot of off-topic noise; pre-selection was by keywords and then manual, so individual relevant papers outside the core journals may be missing.

GeoNews is an automatically compiled digest published by Dr. Markus L. Fischer, Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam. The thematic profile follows his research interests; selection is made by a rule-based workflow, not an editorial team. The digest is an independent literature overview with no affiliation to the publishers or funding bodies mentioned and does not constitute a recommendation or advice. Details may contain errors; when in doubt, the linked original source prevails. Corrections and comments are welcome.